

Seawall height in Pompano Beach

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

POMPANO BEACH • BROWARD COUNTY

5.0

 ft NAVD88 minimum

Pompano Beach sets both ends of the range. A tidal flood barrier must reach 5 ft NAVD88 and must not exceed 5 ft 10 in NAVD88, so a wall can be too high as well as too low.

The detail

MINIMUM	5 ft NAVD88
MAXIMUM	5 ft 10 in NAVD88. § 151.05(A).
WHEN AN EXISTING WALL MUST BE RAISED	On substantial repair or rehabilitation, and when work on attached structures exceeds 50% of the barrier's cost.
HOW MUCH OF THE WALL	The whole shoreline of the property, not only the section being repaired.
ALTERNATIVES	A seawall is not required where another measure is an equally effective tidal flood barrier. Automatic systems are allowed if they do not need daily human intervention.
CAP PROJECTION	A seawall cap may not extend more than 36 inches seaward of the existing wet face. § 151.05(M).
RIPRAP OR AN APPROVED ALTERNATIVE	Natural lime rock riprap, or other approved habitat enhancement, at the waterward face. § 151.05(H).
NO PRE-2035 ROUTE	§ 151.05(A) sets the 5 ft minimum with no 4 ft allowance for early applications, unlike the county text in Broward County Code Sec. 39-407(a).
WHERE THE NEW FACE MAY GO	Unless the City Engineer approves, a reconstructed barrier's wet face may sit no more than 12 inches from the existing wet face. § 151.05(N).

Before you call a contractor

1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3 Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4 Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.